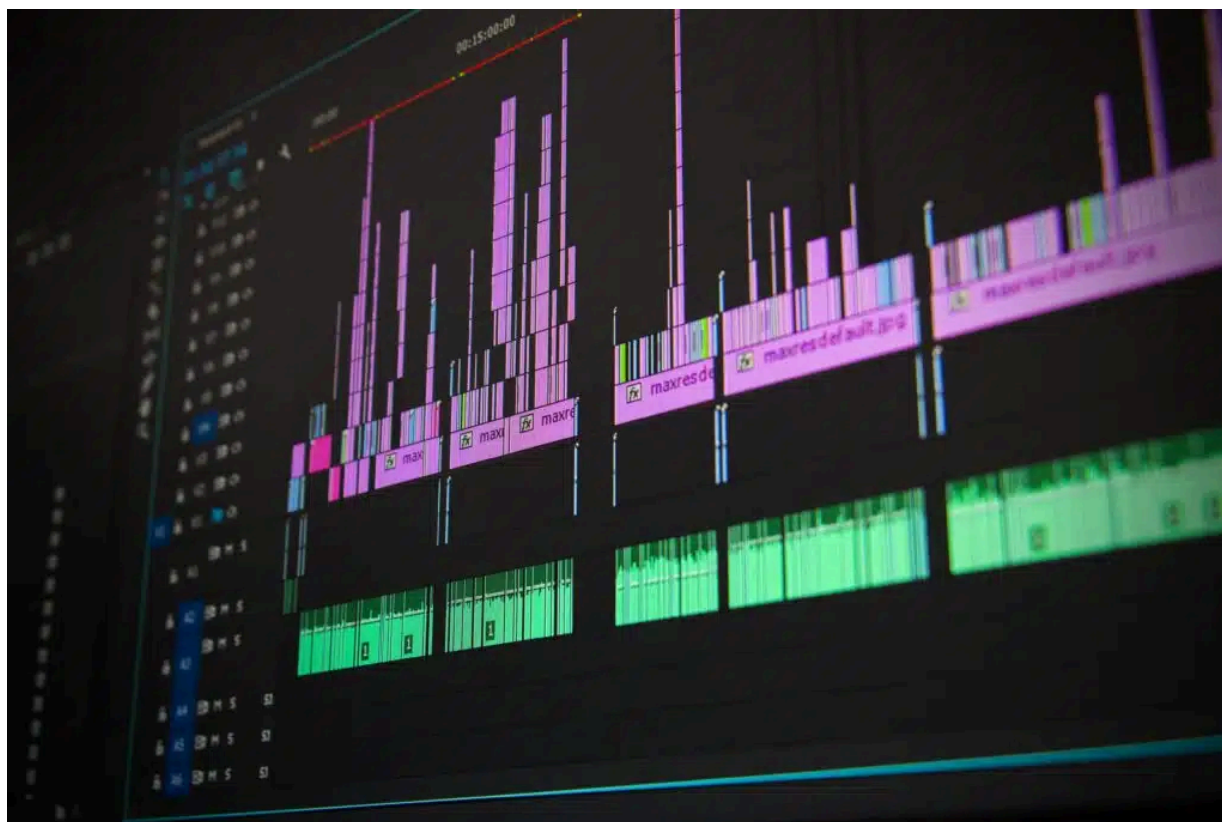


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[< Previous Topic](#)[Next Topic >](#)

I2. The BTS

The Brevet de Technicien Supérieur (BTS) is a two-year French post-secondary diploma. The **BTS is offered in 88 specialty fields** and has been harmonised with the European LMD (Licence, Master, Doctorat) degree ladder. More than 240,000 students are enrolled in BTS programmes in France.



In part, BTS programmes are designed to keep pace with new labour market requirements, especially with respect to emerging needs for new, specialised technical skills across the economy. BTS programmes aim to respond to the need for personnel with the appropriate technical skills and competencies, with the goal of graduating students that are “job ready” and that can begin their careers immediately after graduation.

Students may pursue a BTS across a wide range of specialties including engineering and technology, tourism, business and the arts. The complete subject range is as follows:

- Civil engineering and construction
- Industry (e.g., materials processing, fabrication, equipment maintenance)
- Information technology, digital technology
- Engineering
- Business and management
- Communication and information
- Economic and social (e.g., health and social services)
- Tourism, hotel management
- Health services
- Agriculture and Environment
- Arts and Apparel

BTS programmes may be taught either in a public or private secondary school, (a *lycée*), or in a vocational training centre. Along with their classroom studies, students must spend 14 to 18 weeks in internships each year during the second semester. Those internship placements are coordinated by a faculty tutor.

Tuition and fees vary by type of institution: public secondary schools require a registration fee only, private secondary schools under contract with the government require between €300 and €900, and other institutions under no government contract will require from €1,500 to €6,000.

Various post-BTS degree options are possible, depending on the specific BTS programme the student has followed. BTS graduates may enter science-oriented preparatory programmes, for example, leading to the *Grandes Écoles*, or undergraduate programmes leading to a *Licence professionnelle* (more on which in section I4), or even certain schools of engineering for more advanced studies.

